FIELD NOTES SANITY MIGRATIONS

Your redesign will lose traffic.

Unless you map every URL first.

01 THE PROBLEM

Google ranks URLs. Change one and its ranking starts from zero.

02 REDIRECTS IN ONE MIGRATION

4,812

Every one mapped by hand before launch day.

03 BEFORE YOU TOUCH THE DESIGN

Four things to export first.

01 Every live URL

02 Backlinks by page

03 Top 100 pages by traffic

04 Structured data

04 REDIRECTS

× BAD REDESIGN

Point every old URL at the homepage.

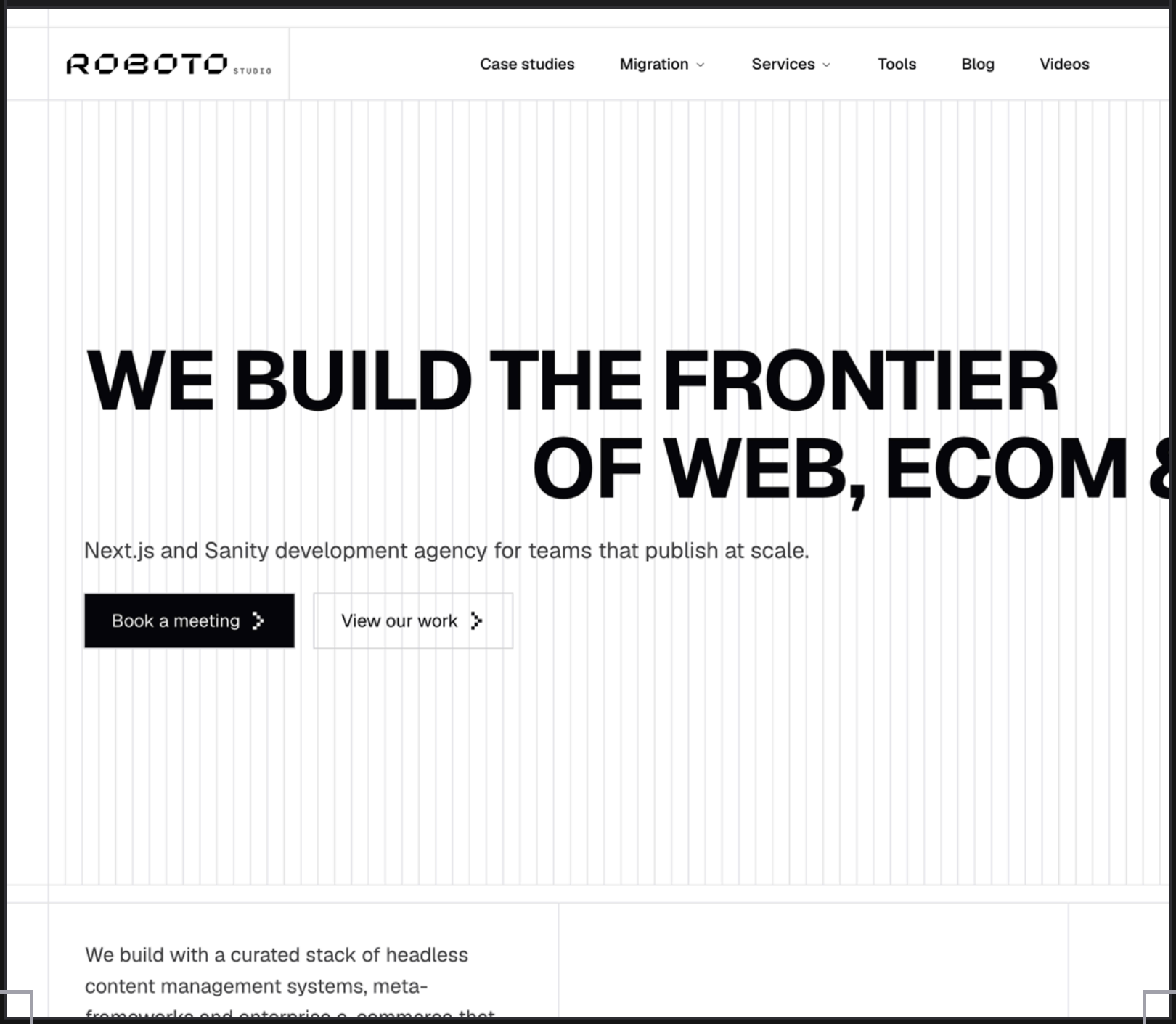
■ GOOD REDESIGN

Map each old URL to its closest new page. One to one, 301.

05 LIVE SITE

Same URLs. New site.

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06 NEXT.CONFIG.TS

The redirect map is the deliverable.

```
// 4,812 of these
{
  source: '/blog/:slug',
  destination: '/insights/:slug',
  permanent: true,
}
```

07 LAUNCH WEEK

MON

Freeze content

TUE

Import to Sanity

WED

Crawl staging

THU

Switch DNS

FRI

Nothing. That's the point.

08 WHAT WE CHECK

Four crawls, one launch.

01 Status codes	02 Canonicals
03 Sitemaps	04 Schema

“The best migration is the one nobody notices.”

JONO ALFORD · ROBOTO STUDIO

09 THE STACK

Boring tools, on purpose.

Sanity

Next.js

Vercel

Screaming Frog

Search Console

10 SAVE THIS

- 01 Export every URL
- 02 Map redirects one to one
- 03 Crawl staging before DNS

What broke in your last migration?

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Get in touch >